

Billing, Payments and Meter Readings

Frequently asked questions

Bills

How often will I get a bill?

Every month. Customers with a smart meter are always billed on actual usage. Customers with a traditional meter are billed on their latest reading, or on an estimate if we haven't had one.

What is an estimated bill?

If we don't have a recent reading, we estimate your usage from your history. Estimated bills are marked with an 'E' next to the reading. As soon as you send a reading, the next bill corrects any difference.

Why is my bill higher than usual?

The most common reasons are: a previous estimate that was too low, higher winter usage from heating and lighting, a new appliance such as a heat pump, tumble dryer or electric car, or the end of a fixed-price contract. The Usage tab in the Kestrel app shows month-by-month consumption.

My account is in credit. Can I get the money back?

Yes. Credit is normally used against your next bills, but you can ask for a refund at any time and we will pay it to your bank account within 10 working days.

Meter readings

How do I submit a meter reading?

In the Kestrel app, through our voice assistant, or by texting READ followed by your account number and reading to 60040. Send the reading within the last 5 days of your billing month. Give the whole numbers only, ignoring anything after the decimal point or in red.

I have a smart meter. Do I need to send readings?

No. Smart meters send readings automatically. If the app shows that your meter hasn't reported for more than a month, contact us and we'll check the connection.

What if I have a two-rate meter?

Two-rate meters show two readings, usually labelled 'low' or 'night' and 'normal' or 'day'. Send both.

Payments

How can I pay?

By monthly Direct Debit, by debit or credit card in the app, by bank transfer quoting your account number, or in cash at any PayPoint. Paying by Direct Debit is the cheapest option and gives a £5 discount on every bill.

How is my Direct Debit amount worked out?

We spread your expected yearly cost evenly across 12 months, so you pay the same in summer and winter. We review it every 6 months and tell you before any change.

What happens if I miss a payment?

We'll send a reminder after 7 days. If you're struggling to pay, please talk to us early – we'll always offer a payment plan that fits your budget before taking any further action, and we never charge late-payment fees.

Can I spread the cost of a large bill?

Yes. Our customer team can set up a payment plan over 3 to 12 months with no extra cost. The voice assistant can raise a request and the team will call you back.

Complaints and switching**How do I make a complaint?**

Through the app, by email, by phone or via the voice assistant. We aim to resolve complaints within 5 working days. If we can't resolve your complaint within 8 weeks, or you're unhappy with our final response, you can take it to the Energy Ombudsman free of charge.

How do I switch to Kestrel Energy?

Just sign up – we handle everything with your old supplier. Switching usually takes around 5 working days, your supply isn't interrupted, and you don't need a new meter.

Are there exit fees?

Kestrel Economy 7, Weekend Saver and Green have no exit fees. Kestrel Fixed has an exit fee of £50 if you leave more than 49 days before the end of the fixed period.